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Twelve New Democrats, including vived a rare first-reading vote.

ESOR

Electric System Operations Review

Reviewing operational issues on Vancouver Island – Jordan River

B.C.Hydro is examining issues related to the way our hydro electric system is currently operated and considering alternatives to address these issues.

We are meeting with stakeholders and collecting data to find the appropriate balance between power production and other uses of the reservoirs and rivers in Hydro's electric system. A report will be submitted to the provincial government.

The Jordan River complex is located approximately 50 km west of Victoria. It consists of Bear Creek Dam, Diversion Dam and Elliott Dam and the Jordan River Generating Station. Each of the dams provide separate pondage for the development, with Diversion Dam supplying most of the storage capacity. Diversion and Elliott Dams are located on the Jordan River, while Bear Creek Dam impounds a reservoir on Bear Creek.

Stakeholders from the Victoria area identified the following key issues related to the effects of Hydro's operations on the Jordan River:

Upstream issues on the Diversion and Bear Creek reservoirs

- fish habitat in the reservoirs is affected by significant drawdown.
- floating debris restricts fishing.
- access to the reservoirs is limited by the exposure of stumps and large mudflats due to drawdown in the summer months. Boating and fishing are also reduced due to low water levels. There is a desire for stabilization of water levels of Bear Creek Reservoir above the current minimum level to improve summertime recreational opportunities.

Issues downstream from the Bear Creek Diversion and Elliott dams

- the absence of a minimum flow requirement for Jordan River may have fishery implications although fish habitat is already limited by steep gradients.
- the Ministry of Environment, Lands and Parks is concerned about dam safety and the potential for flooding and erosion at the mouth of the Jordan River.
- sudden increases in streamflow below Elliott Dam may surprise hikers in areas around the lower Jordan River.

Please call Andrea Wolff at 528-2289 or Harold Gruber at 528-7932 to discuss these or other issues relating to Hydro's use of the Jordan River. Information on operating alternatives is also available upon request.

The Electric System Operations Review (ESOR) B.C.Hydro, 6911 Southpoint Drive, Podium C-03, Burnaby, B.C.,V3N 4X8 or call toll free 1-800-663-1377.

BC hydro

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